

IAS PRELIMS/MAINS



SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY



A COMPREHENSIVE COVERAGE

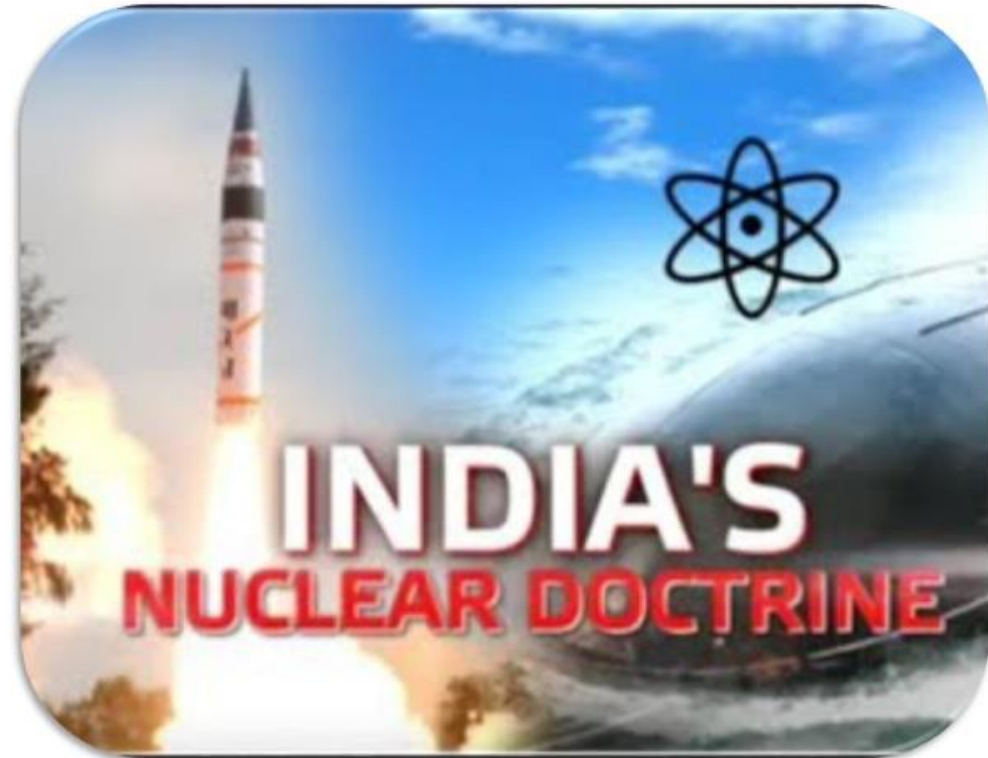
MODULE - 39

NUCLEAR TECHNOLOGY - 5

NUCLEAR TECHNOLOGY

INDIA'S NUCLEAR DOCTRINE

- The nuclear doctrine represents the set of beliefs and principles held by India with regard to the use of its nuclear weapons.
- **Post 1998 nuclear test, India came up with a comprehensive nuclear doctrine to clear doubts and misunderstandings prevailing around the world regarding India's nuclear weapons policy.**
- The Cabinet Committee on Security enunciated the details in 2003. **Through the doctrine India had clarified its stand both nationally and internationally and had earned valuable global support and credibility.**



INDIA'S NUCLEAR DOCTRINE

KEY FEATURES OF INDIA'S NUCLEAR DOCTRINE

a) Building and maintaining a **credible minimum deterrent**.

Credible Minimum Deterrence : Deterrence to be effective must be credible, which includes –

- i. Sufficient and survivable nuclear forces, both in terms of warheads and means of delivery, able to inflict unacceptable damage.
- ii. Nuclear forces must be operationally prepared at all times.
- iii. Effective intelligence and early warning capabilities.
- iv. A robust command and control system.
- v. The will to employ nuclear forces.



INDIA'S NUCLEAR DOCTRINE

KEY FEATURES OF INDIA'S NUCLEAR DOCTRINE

- b) **'No First Use' Policy.** Nuclear weapons will be used only in retaliation against a nuclear attack on Indian territory or on Indian forces anywhere.
- c) Nuclear retaliation to a first strike will be massive and designed to inflict unacceptable damage.
- d) **Nuclear retaliatory attacks to be authorized only by civilian political leadership through the Nuclear Command Authority.**
The political council headed by PM will be the final authority to take decision. This council will be aided by an executive council headed by the NSA. Bestowing the decision on the popularly elected political executive earns India a lot of credibility.



INDIA'S NUCLEAR DOCTRINE

KEY FEATURES OF INDIA'S NUCLEAR DOCTRINE

- e) Non use of nuclear weapons against non-nuclear states.
 - **Credible Minimum Deterrence along with No First Use and No Use Against Non-Nuclear States** clearly indicates that India's Nuclear capability is for defensive purpose only.
- f) Continuance of strict controls on export of nuclear and missile related materials and continued moratorium on testing.
- g) **India to retain the option of retaliating with nuclear weapons in the event of a major attack against it with biological or chemical weapons.**
- h) Continued commitment to the goal of nuclear weapon free world, through disarmament.



INDIA'S NUCLEAR DOCTRINE

ISSUES OVER NO FIRST USE POLICY

■ Arguments supporting NFU

- ✓ India's restraint posture has provided major credibility internationally, including **lifting of economic sanctions**, removal of technology denial regimes and civil nuclear cooperation agreements.
- ✓ Complex command and control and sophisticated intelligence and surveillance systems are necessary for a first use posture.
- ✓ A first use posture will deny India the opportunity to engage in conventional warfare below the nuclear threshold.
- ✓ **First use policy may lead to arms race** and destabilization of the entire South Asia.



INDIA'S NUCLEAR DOCTRINE

ISSUES OVER NO FIRST USE POLICY

- **Arguments against No First Use (NFU)**
 - ✓ Several critics have been critical of the NFU policy, calling it a serious liability during the times of serious war.
 - ✓ **NFU may result in very high initial casualties** and damage to Indian population, cities and infrastructure.
 - ✓ Massive retaliation is not credible, especially after a tactical nuclear strike on Indian forces.
 - ✓ A sophisticated and **expensive ballistic missile defence system** would be required to defend against the first strike.



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